It’s Tricky

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/37901377.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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I think this is the only work tagged catra&sea hawk, thats hilarious, Skateboarding, Minor Injuries, bc they’re stupid

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by PointlesslyPoetic

Summary

A gorgeous day spent at the skatepark goes awry, as all things in Catra’s life seem to. Maybe that’s what she deserves for asking Sea Hawk to hang out.

Notes

This was very fun to write lol hope u enjoy

In hindsight, going to the skatepark with Sea Hawk had been among the Worst Ideas She'd Ever Had. Danger and injury followed that man like a horde of…something that swarms. Whatever. Point being, Catra should've known better, and she ruminated on this tragic lack of foresight as Spinnerella prodded her swollen ankle and 'tsked' under her breath. Her only comfort was listening to Sea Hawk bitch and moan on the medical cot next to her as Netossa apathetically rolled his sprained wrist.

Let's rewind.

– - - – – -

"If I land this, I get your thirty minutes in the mineral tub tomorrow."

"That's a terrible deal. Done."

Catra cackled as she slapped Sea Hawk's palm with her own and walked off to hike up the ramp to the bowl she had her eye on. The sun was finally starting to warm the town around them;now that it was late March and winter was releasing its chokehold on Bright Moon, Washington. The day was clear and sunny in a way it rarely was this time of year, so Catra had grabbed her board, called up Adora, and then been let down immediately. Her best friend was tied up in training for the entire weekend, which made sense– the Plex had meets lined up for all of them. It was worse than tech week at a community theater. She tried Mermista next, and got no answer, so she was probably out on the water by now. It was primo surfing weather, and one couldn't exactly practice that sport indoors with much variation, not that she was ever drowning in free time. Catra had debated Scorpia, but the woman couldn't stay on a board for her life. Perfuma and she had to be in the perfect headspace to vibe, and Catra didn't feel up to that. Bow was out of town for the day with Glimmer to visit his dads, which left-

"Ayo, Sea Hawk!"

Catra watched from the lip of the bowl as a couple of local teens, a bit younger than either of them, came up to her skating buddy for the day and exchanged high fives. She knew Sea Hawk volunteer coached a local high school's varsity fencing team once in a while as a favor to a "friend" (note: most of Sea Hawk's friends weren't actually friends), so she assumed that's where they were from. Either way, it would be sweet if they weren't in the way of her drop in. She cupped a hand to her mouth.

"Yo, Sea Weed! Move your ass or I'm gonna move it for you!"

He flashed her a thumbs up and hustled the kids out of the bowl. Catra took a breath, and found her center of gravity just like she did on the balance beam. Find your position. Deep breath, and hold it until you stop shaking. Breathe out in three…two…

Catra shifted her weight forward, releasing her grip on the lip and relishing in that brief moment of weightlessness before she felt her wheels snap against the brushed concrete and carry her down into the bowl. She focused on her goal, and not her body; that was the easiest way to trip yourself up on a board, by overthinking everything from your foot position to your arms to your lean. Before you knew it you were on your ass. She carved around the swell of the bowl, faster and faster until she whipped out of it, heading for the edge of the bowl where Sea Hawk stood. She climbed and snapped the board to her, popping a fluid ollie and spinning into some frontside air before dropping seamlessly back into the bowl. Woops and hollers followed her, but she was focused in now.

Catra swung a quarter back, still riding the boost from the drop in, and rocketed up the larger wall of the bowl to land a blunt; she balanced her two back wheels on the edge, popped another ollie, and rode down backwards in a fakie. This time she let herself smile. She's almost won the bet. With the last boost of speed, she tucked herself in small to gain as much momentum as possible, before careening up the far side of the bowl right into the air. She was weightless again, spinning once- twice- three times! She

landed hard, but she was grinning as she whipped off her helmet and jogged up to Sea Hawk.

"720! Let's go, that's all your tub time for Monday!" She stuck her tongue out, and while Sea Hawk did look annoyed, he also looked extremely impressed.

"That was incredible! The way you move," he whistled, and from any other guy it would be weird and maybe kind of cringey. But Sea Hawk was the kind of guy who was so ridiculous that it looped back around to being genuine, so she took it for the compliment it was. "Remind me to come catch your meet this week."

"Hey, the more the merrier," Catra shrugged, ever aloof. "Bigger audience, more people cheering for little ol' me."

"So humble. Alright, what's mine?"

"Depends. What's the bet this time?"

He stroked his just-this-side-of-working-for-him mustache, humming. "If I land this, you have to come to one of my bouts."

"Ugh!" Catra groaned. "Fencing is boring!"

"That's because you've never seen me fence!" Sea Hawk puffed like a peacock. "Epee's are fast, but strategic thinkers. We're a wonder to watch!"

Catra smirked. "Ohhhh, I see. So is that why Mermista's been at all your bouts lately? Because you're a 'wonder to watch'?"

To his credit, Sea Hawk only blushed a little. "Well, I'm sure it's for the same reasons that Adora's been at your last three floor shows. You and I must simply be something else." Sea Hawk winked at her like he knew something she didn't, and Catra sneered.

"And what's that supposed to mean, you fucking-"

“Oh, hey look! Shin Split Ramp is open!” Sea Hawk jabbed a finger past her head, and Catra swiveled to follow it. Sure enough, the notorious, infamous “ramp” was free of suicidal skaters. Some zoning moron had obviously not measured something right, because the thing was borderline lethal; skaters had been breaking limbs and teeth on it since its construction. Nearly twenty-five feet tall, it was the only thing in the park Catra had ever purposely avoided. Not that she’d be sharing that with Sea Weed.

“Yeah, I’m down,” she shrugged. “We makin’ it fun?”

“Hmmmm,” Sea Hawk stroked his mustache. “Double or nothing for the hot tub? I want my minutes back. What are we doing for it?”

“Straight down, hit the box jump for a kickflip, ride the wave to the spine and grind it, ollie, and a 360 off the box. You win if you can get through it with two pushes or less. And if you don’t break anything.”

“Har, har,” Sea Hawk hiked his board over his shoulder. “Let’s go! Adventure!”

As they climbed the steps to their doom, Catra mused on her own intellect. Of their little cadre of athletes, Adora and Sea Hawk most often got labelled as stupid, or impulsive. And that wasn’t untrue. But Catra had never been one to back down from anything, no matter how stupid the dare, when her pride was on the line. She was just smarter about getting herself into these situations in the first place. Well, usually. Sea Hawk canceled out all of her luck, it seemed.

“Cool if I film this for Tiktok?”

“I insist you do!” Sea Hawk grinned, and flashed her a ‘hang-loose’ sign before trotting over to the lip of the drop. Surprisingly, it was empty up here. Catra hit record, and gave him the thumbs up. Sea Hawk mounted up, strapped his helmet on tight, slapped

it hard twice, and with a whoop of adrenaline, vanished over the edge. Catra moved to the edge to follow him with the camera. And she had to begrudgingly admit, there was a reason they called him 'Sea Hawk' on and off the fencing strip; he was gliding down the near-vertical incline like a bird. He wobbled as he leveled off the dive, but recovered well. He hit the box jump hard and fast, but his kickflip was immaculate. He nearly lost it on the jump onto the ramp, so even Catra found herself cheering when he pulled it off. He ollied off the grind, and pushed once hard on his way back to the box. It was tight, but yes! He nailed the 360 and hit the ground with a loud crack. Both hands went up in the air as he cheered, and Catra laughed as she clapped along from behind the camera. She cut the video, and Sea Hawk clambered back up. She slapped his proffered palm and nodded.

"That was sick as fuck, dude. You get the minutes. Alright, what's mine? And what's the wager?"

And so they killed about four hours on Shin Split Ramp, coming up with crazier and more elaborate sequences for one another, with sillier and sillier wagers. By the time five was rolling around, Catra had agreed to a fencing match, a trip to the Jamba Juice on Saturday, a karaoke night duet, and stealing one of Bow's fancy fiberglass and titanium arrows. Sea Hawk had agreed to washing her bike, going with her to one of Adora's fights (and NOT as a wingman, thank you), an hour on the uneven bars, and a drag show downtown hosted by their mutual acquaintance Double Trouble.

"Alright, I'm getting hungry," Sea Hawk yawned. "One more? Loser buys dinner?"

"Yeah, let's make it easy. Drop in same time, up the half pipe, first one up wins."

"A race! Love it," he clapped his hands with relish. "Let's go, I want wings."

They mounted up, and counted down together before they dropped. After hours of this, Catra felt comfortable throwing her weight more forward than she would normally, and was edging ahead bit by bit. She had this in the bag, she was going to order the biggest, greasiest burger-

WHAM!

Something heavy and loud slammed into her from the right, sending her careening into Sea Hawk. Their boards collided, and in an effort to correct, Catra stupidly put her foot on the ground out of instinct. Her balance wrecked, she fell into Sea Hawk and they both went down hard. Sea Hawk hit the pavement first and yelled in definite pain and confusion, while Catra bounced against him and rolled a bit. Her training made her tuck in to protect her soft center from damage, but she could already feel white hot pain lancing through her ankle. Her ears were ringing, and she tasted blood, and when she opened her eyes, it took a few minutes to stop seeing a laggy double of everything.

Sea Hawk was staggering over to her, left wrist cradled against his body. He offered her his good hand, and she hauled herself up with it. She was upright for all of two seconds before she tried to put weight on her left foot … and folded like a lawn chair.

"Ow! Fuck!" Catra rocked back to sit on her ass with her leg out. Sea Hawk moved to help, but they were interrupted by the ignoramus who had crashed into them.

"Why didn't you two fairies watch where you were fucking going?"

Oh, hell no. "We had right of way, you fucking knob!" Catra screamed at the roided out teen who was lumbering toward them. Bald head, weird musculature, a suspicious looking tattoo covered by an armband. Skinhead ass

"Like hell you did-"

Sea Hawk stood and stopped the kid's angry advance. "If you don't mind, we're both hurt, and I've half a mind to break your

nose. Back off, please.” He said pleasantly, but firmly.

“I’d like to you see try, fa-”

Sea Hawk shrugged, and cracked a fist across the dude’s jaw faster than Catra had expected him to. The burning in her ankle was cooling, and she rolled experimentally- no break, just a sprain. She got to her feet, leaning on her right side, and reached inside her jacket for where she kept her brass knuckles. They may live in a gentrified area of the city, but one could never be too safe, and Catra liked to be prepared. Besides, they’d been a gift from Adora, shaped like a cat with pointy ears. The ogre stumbled to his feet, and Catra flashed a bit of the red metal. Two of his deadened brain cells must have rubbed together in just the right way for his smooth brain to pop out a coherent thought, because he paused, and then backed off. He grabbed his board and headed for the gate.

“Thank gods,” Sea Hawk muttered. “My wrist is fucked.”

“Yeah, I’m not so sure about walking right now,” They decided on a dignified hobble; Sea Hawk supported her on the left, and she carried their boards under her right arm. “We never talk about this.”

“Probably for the best.”

They fell into the bucket seats of Sea Hawk’s modified Civic with twin groans. “We need a doctor.”

“Fuck no,” Sea Hawk all but whined. “Are you broken?”

“I don’t think so, just sprained. You?”

“Same. Maybe also somewhat concussed.”

“Nothing new for you,” Catra snorted, but it jostled the bruising along her side and she groaned. “If we go to an Urgent Care, they’re going to aircast us for sure. And then we have to do check

ups during this hell week, and our coaches will never put us in with casts."

"So, we go home and enjoy a dinner of painkillers and muscle cream and pray no one notices tomorrow?"

"See? You're not as stupid as everyone says."

"That's the nicest thing you've ever said to me."

Sea Hawk dropped her off at her apartment in the Athlete's Village before taking off. Most of their little gang lived in the Village, save for Mermista, whose parents were renting her a nice apartment uptown, and Bow and Adora and Glimmer who split a borderline penthouse about a mile away, courtesy of Glimmer's loaded mother. They'd offered a room to Catra, but truth be told, she liked her little two-bedroom, cramped and cluttered in a way that said "I'm here! This is mine!", rather than poverty or carelessness. She had piles of books, knick knacks from competing around the world, plants Perfuma forced on her routinely, and a roommate from ye old Motherland (sort of).

Said roommate, Kaninia, was no longer awake, having probably collapsed the second she hit her bed. Catra, for all she said otherwise, knew how intensive figure skating practices were, especially right now; Olympic trials were in two months, and she probably wouldn't be seeing much of her roommate until they were over. Nini had been kind enough to leave her a plate of vareniki in the microwave, which she let heat up while she rummaged for her painkiller stash. As she was popping two Aleve P.M.s, her phone dinged, and she swiped open a text from Scorpia. It was a picture of Sea Hawk, face down on the couch with his busted wrist hanging over the edge; he'd duct taped two dripping ziploc bags of ice to it and called it square. Catra made a mental note to ice before bed.

Wildcat: LMAO nice

Scorp: what happened :(((

Wildcat: don’t worry about it, he’s just being dramatic

Scorp: I think he took a Perc

Oh fuck

Wildcat: imma FT, answer

Scorpia answered in record time. “Hey!”

“Hey.” Catra grunted as she yanked her dumplings out of the microwave. She balanced the plate on her arm and grabbed her phone, water, and a fork with her other hand. “Gimme a sec to get to my room.”

Once she was situated on her bed, she let Scorpia speak. “What happened to you two?”

“Nothing major,” she fibbed. “Just took a tumble together off a vert ramp, you know how it is. We’ll be right as rain in, like, a day.”

“Catra,” Scorpia was using her ‘I mean business voice’, which was, unfortunately for her, just as kind as her normal voice. “I know you’re not telling the truth.”

“Congrats. Do you want a medal?”

“Don’t make me wake up Adora and send her across town to the Village. You know I will.”

Catra growled. That was unfair, but she knew Scorpia was telling the truth. Adora was the only one of them with EMS-level training, and had become their on-the-go doctor in situations like this. She already knew exactly what Adora would say; she couldn’t compete on her ankle. “Alright, fine. Gods. We got into an accident, it’s a long story, but I- I think I pulled and twisted or maybe even sprained my ankle, and Sea Hawk definitely has a concussion and he hurt his wrist.”

“He took a perc for a concussion? I’m going to kill him,” Scorpia scrubbed her red prosthetic hand through her crew cut. “This is bad, Wildcat. You two have meets coming up this week!”

“You think I don’t know that?” Catra yelled before she could catch herself and stuff the anger back in its little box. She didn’t want to wake Kaninia. “Look, if I really can’t move by tomorrow, I won’t go to the meet. It’s more important that I get better in time for Pre-Quals.”

“What you need is to talk to Spinnerella as soon as you get in tomorrow.” Scorpia was frowning.

“Oh, please, what’s she going to do? Wiggle my foot and go yeah that’s definitely fucked up. Here’s some pills you already have and exercises you already know how to do. Please.”

Scorpia sighed. “I know there’s no convincing you about this, so I’m giving up on this one little thing for now. However,” she fixed Catra with A Look. “If I see even one sign on distress out of you tomorrow, I’m carrying you to the PT office myself.”

“Fine, whatever,” Catra sighed. “I’m icing and going to bed now. Make sure Sea Weed doesn’t die in his sleep, I don’t wanna deal with that fallout.”

“Night, Wildcat.”

“Night, Scorp.”

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As it turned out, Scorpia didn’t need to keep a sharp eye out for a reason to send Catra to the infirmary. Every morning, because they were all beyond extra, everyone gathered in Fitness Room A to run through warm-ups together, and then break away to do their cardio, strength training, agility, - whatever - in groups or pairs. After that they would go to their respective practices. In the beginning, it had almost been too much for Catra; back in Russia, practice and warmups was, at most, a team activity. There was no

joking, no tips or spotters, no laughter, and definitely no comfort or encouragement when you screwed up. She could tolerate it now, but it was still strange to her. She had seen the same apprehension on Adora and Mermista's faces, the only other two who hadn't been born and raised in the States.

Catra and Sea Hawk barely glanced at one another during warm up stretches in an effort to eschew any suspicion. She'd managed to get out the door and to the Plex this morning without limping, she was proud to admit. Ignoring Scorpia's concern was easy, she'd been doing it for years, but Adora's scrutiny wasn't something she could dodge as fluidly.

"You good, Catra?" The taller blonde had her arms bent backwards at an unnatural angle.

"Yeah, fine." Catra was often grumpy in the morning, and she hoped Adora would let it go. Not that Adora was really known for letting anything go, like, ever. "Just exhausted."

Adora just hummed, and, to Catra's eternal chagrin, plopped down next to her for the floor portion of Perfuma's warm up (which was treacherously close to yoga- something Catra hated). She did her best to keep sweat from beading too heavily on her forehead, and to keep pressure off her ankle as subtly as possible. Her luck held out, too, for all of thirty minutes. They were all splitting up for strength and cardio when disaster struck.

Sea Hawk was leaning against a rack of weights, flirting with an annoyed Mermista, nothing abnormal. He shifted oddly, one of the smaller discs came loose, and Catra watched in slow motion as his bad hand shot out on reflex to grab it. Catch it he did, but he howled in pain and dropped it again just as fast, cradling his hand against his chest. When he dropped the disk, it rolled in directly toward Catra, and in a cosmically comical turn of events, lightly tapped her busted ankle, sending her to the floor. "FUCK!"

Adora was at her side in an instant. "Catra! What happened, are you okay?"

“Wildcat!” Aaaand there was Scorpia. “I told you both this wasn’t going to work, c’mon.”

“Told them both what wasn’t going to work?” Mermista had an arm around Sea Hawk, her frosty disdain laced with a scant layer of concern.

“Uh- I- They-”

Sea Hawk came to his best friend’s rescue. “We both made her promise to keep our, erm, minor, superfluous injuries to herself so as to not alarm the rest of you. That’s all.”

“Superfluous?” Perfuma had heard the commotion and came over with Bow in tow. “This seems a bit more serious than that. Bow, why don’t you jog ahead and tell Spinnerella they’re coming in?”

The archer nodded and bounded off.

Catra tried to protest, but an icy glare from Adora shut her down. “Catra, this is serious! You have qualifiers coming up! How did this happen?”

“Uh…” She had the good graces to blush. “It’s, ah, kind of a funny story, really?”

“Oh, hilarious, truly,” Sea Hawk supported her. “We laughed for a good…long…ahem, while.” He trailed off as Mermista’s glare shifted from annoyed to vicious.

Adora shook her head. “C’mon, you both need the infirmary.” Before Catra could stagger to her feet, Adora stood and scooped her up in a bridal carry.

“Hey! What-”

“It’s just easier this way, Catra. Stop being a brat.”

Behind her, Sea Hawk was snickering and looking far too amused, so as they set off out of the gym, she turned to Mermista. “He’s

definitely concussed, and he knew that when he took a Percocet last night."

The grin melted off Sea Hawk's face as the surfer rounded on him. "You what-!"

Adora smartly picked up the pace and left the other two behind to their daily argument. "Catra, why did you even try to lie about this?"

"Uh, because it's super embarrassing? Because it's just a little sprain, and they happen all the time? Because I knew you all would do this? Take your pick."

"You didn't need to tell everyone! I mean, you obviously already told Scorpia…"

The way Adora's sentence trailed off into a sad little huff had Catra's ears straining. "Adora…are you jealous that I told Scorpia I got hurt and not you?"

"What! Pfft, no, I'm- what- who said anything about jealousy? You're ridiculous-"

"Awwww," Catra chuckled. "It's okay Adora, you know you're still my bestie- ew, bleh, I hate that word."

"Well, if I am your bestie," Adora put enough emphasis on the word that Catra's eyes rolled harder than her ankle. "Why didn't you call and tell me?"

"Because!" Catra tossed her shoulders up in a shrug. "I dunno…I guess I didn't want you to worry, or whatever, because you're always worrying about everything. Plus you get kind of nuts when any of us get hurt."

"What! I do not." Catra raised an eyebrow, and gestured grandly to the position Adora had put them in. She had the good grace to look sheepish, at least, after that. "Oh…uh, heh, yeah okay. I guess that's fair."

“Why are you so butthurt I didn’t call you as soon as I hit the concrete?”

“Is that what happened?” Adora snorted, but quickly schooled her features back into order. “Sorry, sorry. I guess I just get nervous.”

“You don’t say,” Catra snarked. “About what?”

“Well, two years ago, we couldn’t stand each other. Now you’re my best friend. It’s kind of fast, all things considered, and…some days I get scared that it’s all gonna go away again. That you’ll stop telling me things, or start picking other people over me. And I know that’s just me being insecure, and that’s not on you-”

“Woah, Adora, calm down!” Catra held up a soothing hand. Adora took a breath, and finally paused. “It’s okay. I’m not mad, or whatever. Thanks for, uh, telling me?” Adora smiled, so Catra figured she was on the right emotional path. “I get being insecure, especially all things considered. But, c’mon, do you really think I’m just gonna wake up one day and say ` well, that was fun, moving on’?”

Because if she did…ouch.

“No! Of course not!” Adora’s eyes widened. “I’m just an idiot about this stuff.”

“Maybe,” Catra hummed, and jostled her. “But you’re my idiot.”

Adora laughed. “Whatever you say.”

They rounded the corner to the office, where Spinnerella and her wife, Netossa, were outside waiting with Bow. They tsked in tandem when they saw the four of them. “What did you two do?” Netossa groaned. She was Head Athletic Director of the Plex, which essentially meant she was everyone’s coach in some way or another, however far removed.

While Sea Hawk and Catra told their humiliating tale of hubris, Spinerella got them settled in record time, and dismissed Bow

back to practice while allowing Mermista and Adora to wait around for a bit. She prodded Catra's ankle, testing its range of motion and feeling along the muscle for any signs of tear. She jotted something down on her clipboard, and turned to get Sea Hawk's concussion test notes and ankle prognosis from her wife. She turned to them both with a sigh.

"You're both very, very lucky nothing is broken, and that these are only mild sprains. Catra, you need to stay off that leg for twenty four hours, icing every hour for twenty minutes give or take. Solomon, you, too. Is that your fencing wrist?"

"I'm ambidextrous," he crowed. "So I can use either hand."

Spinnerella was nonplussed. "Regardless, you're out of practice for today, too. You need to rest, especially with that concussion. Adora, Mermista, I'll write you both passes to make sure they get back home and into their beds."

Sea Hawk looked less than thrilled with this development. "Oh, no, really- that's alright, I can manage myself."

"You most certainly cannot," Netossa muttered, scribbling some notes onto a pad that she ripped off and handed to Mermista, who took it balefully. "And neither can Catra. Adora, Mermista, I'm trusting you two to get them home and secured with whatever non-narcotic medication and comfort they need for 24 hours of bedrest, and be back here within the hour."

"Yes, ma'am."

"Duh."

Catra let Adora help her into one of the wheelchairs on standby, slouching into the unforgiving plastic with as much dignity as she could muster. Spoiler alert: it wasn't much. Mermista was much less gentle with Sea Hawk, hauling him to his feet and wrapping an iron arm around his torso to drag him toward her car. "What are the odds you'll stop by Chipotle on the way back to my place?"

“So slim they call them shady. Now, shut up.”

“Yes, ma’am.”

Catra smothered a chuckle as Mermista turned to head toward the upper level car park, while Adora brought her down to the lower decks. “Hey, Adoraaaa?”

“Yes, Catra?”

“Can we get Chipotle?”

Adora laughed, and the sound made Catra’s lips curl up into a soft smile that, all things considered, she really didn’t deserve to wear. “Sure, Catra. Just don’t tell Sea Hawk.”

Then again, maybe she did.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!